



Although women had actively participated in the revolution, women's issues were not a priority for the Bolsheviks, and none of the revolutionaries' senior leaders were female. Zhenotdel, the "women's section" of the Communist Party, was set up in 1919, but during its short history (it closed in 1930) was never taken seriously by party officials. Activists such as Alexandra Kollontai, the founder of Zhenotdel, tried to inject more gender diversity into the party but its members mostly rejected

the idea of their wives as political activists. Nonetheless, women achieved some advances, including receiving the right to vote in 1917, and obtaining a divorce more easily. At the same time, women began to play an increasing role in public life, and, by the 1930s, many women worked outside the household as teachers,

▼ **The idealist state**

A Chinese propaganda poster entitled "Soldier, People, One Family" places a revolutionary mother at the center of the message.

